

1. llm 0.32.1

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-21T17:16:13+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/21/llm/>

Release: llm 0.32.1 Fresh installs of LLM stopped working the other day because the OpenAI Python library dropped its usage of httpx , and it turned out LLM depended on that library but only installed it via a transitive openai dependency. This dot-release fixes that for the moment by pinning to openai , and a soon-to-drop 0.33 release will switch from httpx to httpx2 . Tags: httpx , openai , llm

2. llm-openrouter 0.7

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-21T16:58:19+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/21/llm-openrouter/>

Release: llm-openrouter 0.7 Now that this plugin is compatible with LLM 0.32 it works much better with reasoning LLMs available through OpenRouter. Updated for compatibility with LLM 0.32 . Models now use OpenRouter's implementation of the Responses API . Three new server-side tools: Shell , WebFetch , and WebSearch . Enable these with options like -T WebSearch . Tags: llm , openrouter

3. Stop Making TUIs

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-21T16:07:32+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/21/stop-making-tuis/>

Stop Making TUIs Thomas Ptacek advocates for building real native user interfaces for even the smallest of personal tools, because coding agents have reduced the cost of getting a usable-enough GUI up and running to almost nothing. I wrote about my vibe-coded bandwidth and GPU monitoring macOS task bar apps back in March , and I'm still using both of those on a daily basis. I'm not habitually knocking out real UIs for my other projects yet, but I'm running out of excuses! Thomas: If you haven't tried your hand at turning one of your 500 throwaway CLIs into a native app, you're doing yourself a disservice. Go build a native UI. It'll probably change the way you think. Tags: thomas-ptacek , ai , generative-ai , llms , vibe-coding , coding-agents

4. The Fourth Horseman of the File-Format-Hegemony Apocalypse

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-21T23:18:40Z

Link: <https://techcommunity.microsoft.com/blog/onedriveblog/introducing-markdown-support-in-sharepoint-and-onedrive/4512174>

Microsoft's iPhone app for OneDrive has long supported creating three new document types via a big + button right in its file viewer: Excel, Word, PowerPoint. It recently came to my attention that they've added a fourth document type, and they even gave it real Microsoft-style ? they just have no taste ? file icon. Just look at it . The whole world's coming to an end, Mallory. ?

5. Walmart Finally Caves, Will Soon Support Apple Pay

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-21T19:34:55Z

Link: <https://corporate.walmart.com/news/2026/08/21/more-ways-to-pay-tap-to-pay-is-coming-to-walmart-and-sams-club>

Walmart: When we think about convenience, we think about a lot of things, but making shopping feel simpler and more seamless from start to finish is a big part. And one of the moments where that matters most is at checkout. We want customers and members to have choice in how they pay, so they can check out in the way that works best for them. Now, beginning Aug. 24, we will be adding Tap to Pay to our payment options at select Walmart stores and Sam's Club locations, with plans to roll it out to all U.S. stores and clubs by the end of 2026 and to fuel stations by mid-2027. When I think about convenience, I think about CurrentC , scanning stupid-ass QR

codes, and waiting 12 years to adopt Apple Pay. ?

6. ? When New DF Posts Drop in a Forest and No One Is There to Read Them

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-21T16:09:11Z

Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/08/df_posts_drop_in_a_forest

<https://daringfireball.net/>

7. Reducing C++ template bloat by factoring out the type-dependent portions of the function, practical exam

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Fri, 21 Aug 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260821-00/?p=112632>

Applying our principles. The post Reducing C++ template bloat by factoring out the type-dependent portions of the function, practical exam appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. Reducing C++ template bloat by factoring out the type-dependent portions of the function

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Thu, 20 Aug 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260820-00/?p=112629>

Looking for consolidation points. The post Reducing C++ template bloat by factoring out the type-dependent portions of the function appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. You should never be angry at work

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Sat, 22 Aug 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/you-should-never-be-angry-at-work/>

I try not to give a lot of prescriptive advice about working in tech companies 1 . There are many ways to be successful, and every company works differently. If you're shipping projects and your management chain is happy, it doesn't really matter how you've accomplished it. However, there's one thing that I do think is solid advice: you should never be angry at work .

Anger in the workplace Anger in the workplace is toxic. An angry colleague immediately becomes a new problem to be managed, not a professional helping you manage problems. When someone is visibly angry in a meeting or in Slack, it kills the entire atmosphere: other engineers will often go quiet entirely, not wanting to make the situation worse. If you routinely get heated at work, the best-case scenario is that you're part of a tight-knit team of confident people who aren't put off by it 2 . No harm, no foul. But the second someone comes onto your team who's not so confident, or you have to communicate outside of your team, it becomes a big problem. Healthy workplaces route around anger in the same way that networks route around damage. Emotionally unreliable engineers will get left out of conversations that might...

10. Readers can't identify watermarked AI text

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Fri, 21 Aug 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/readers-cant-identify-watermarked-ai-text/>

In the last few weeks, I've been complaining that everyone is wrong about AI watermarking: it isn't really anti-consumer and it doesn't make the outputs any worse. The watermarking papers demonstrate 1 that this is true, but I thought it might be interesting to put it to a practical test. Given examples of watermarked and unwatermarked answers to the same prompt, could readers tell which is which? To find out, I vided up 2 <https://sgoedecke.github.io/watermark-quiz/> , a static site that quizzes readers. I used Qwen3-30B-A3B-Instruct-2507 on a rented H200 to generate thirty responses: three responses per question, one of which was secretly watermarked with SynthID-Text. The rented GPU cost around two dollars. To measure results, I just sent users to a different page for each score, and aggregated visitors-per-page in my analytics 3 .

This would be easily spoofable if anyone cared enough to do so, but for a casual test I think it's acceptable. The first round of traffic I got to the quiz (278 participants) had these slightly puzzling results: Score Participants 0 6 1 15 2 36 3 64 4 54 5 39 6 51 7 10 8 3 9 0 10 0 Pure random choice would lead to an average score of 3.33/10. However,...

11. How would you know whether an ancient culture had zero?

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Fri, 21 Aug 2026 13:14:28 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/21/ancient-number-system/>

A few weeks ago I wrote about the number system used in labeling spreadsheet columns. Labels run from A through Z, then AA through AZ, etc. This looks a lot like base 26, but it's not quite the same. It has no analog of zero. If Z were like zero, Y would be followed by [?] The post How would you know whether an ancient culture had zero? first appeared on John D. Cook .

12. Rust Glancer

Source: matklad | Published: 2026-08-21T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://matklad.github.io/2026/08/21/rust-glancer.html>

Rust Glancer, a functional LSP server for Rust which uses two orders of magnitude less RAM, is incredibly cool. Go check it out! This post started as a comment on lobste.rs, but I figured it out that it's better to publish it somewhat more prominently. Don't expect polished writing though!

13. Book Review: An Immense World - How Animal Senses Reveal the Hidden Realms Around Us by Ed Yong ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Fri, 21 Aug 2026 11:34:36 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/book-review-an-immense-world-how-animal-senses-reveal-the-hidden-realms-around-us-by-ed-yong/>

This is a detailed examination of the various senses possessed by animals. Some will be intimately familiar to you - like sight and sound - whereas some will seem strange and uncanny - like magnetic detection and electro-sensing. Some straddle an almost understandable space like echolocation or tetra-chromatic vision. This isn't a game of Top Trumps where all the animals are ranked by power.?

14. My agent.md to improve LLM-assisted code quality

Source: Fabien Sanglard | Published: 21 Aug 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://fabiansanglard.net/agent.md/index.html>

(No summary)

15. A Need for Speed

Source: The Digital Antiquarian | Published: Fri, 21 Aug 2026 15:36:02 +0000

Link: <https://www.filfre.net/2026/08/a-need-for-speed/>

Looking back from the vantage point of today, it's hard for even me to believe, but it's true all the same: I used to be a full-blown car guy. I bought my first car, a 1966 Volkswagen Beetle, for \$800 in 1989, when I was sixteen years old. The bad thing about a Beetle was [?]

16. Pluralistic: Born on technology's third base (21 Aug 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Sat, 22 Aug 2026 01:19:10 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/08/21/world-historic-forces/>

Today's links Born on technology's third base: Material forces shape life-chances. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Glue; iPods v unions; RIP Jack Layton; Gibson on cities; Britain's sweatshop for terminally ill help-hcalls; NYPL's open CDN; Radical juries. Upcoming appearances: Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Born on technology's third base (permalink) Any frank assessment of your own achievements starts with an equally frank assessment of the world-historic forces that attended those achievements. For example, I often tell young people who want to get into tech, "Well, if you don't have the foresight and work ethic to be born in 1971, I can't really help you." When it comes to tech, being born in 1971 ? to a computer scientist father, no less ? conferred a tremendous advantage for my career chances. My dad ? a refugee ? came to Canada at a time when post-war public services meant that

he could become the first person in his family to go to university, all the way to a...

17. In Purgatory Everyone Likes Crepes: My Time at a Greek All-Inclusive

Source: matduggan.com | Published: Fri, 21 Aug 2026 09:00:05 GMT

Link:

<https://matduggan.com/in-purgatory-everyone-likes-crepes-my-time-at-a-greek-all-inclusive/>

I can't remember the last time I was actually hot. It's a thought that keeps looping through my head as I stand next to a children's play structure in a Greek all-inclusive waterpark. The sun is beating down on an international community of

18. Why shaming people about AI slop isn't enough to stop Big AI

Source: Anil Dash | Published: 2026-08-21T00:00:00Z

Link: <https://anildash.com/2026/08/21/ai-slop-and-shame/>

These days, the conversation in tech and business, and in a lot of society, is still all AI, all the time. And one of the most fundamental questions boils down to: How do you get people to change what they're doing in regard to AI? For people who (understandably) have moral or ethical objections to the many harms caused by Big AI, there's the challenge of how to drive action while lacking the resources and capital of the tech tycoons who've driven the broad cultural push towards AI adoption. As a result of the power differential between those pushing AI and those fighting its advances, the typical rhetorical tactic for AI critics has been to try to attach stigma to the use of AI, and to the outputs of AI systems. There is also little cultural discussion, or even mention, of alternative offerings that aren't from the Big AI companies, so the entire narrative is framed as either using the most harmful, exploitative, damaging AI tools from the likes of OpenAI, or using nothing at all. And for the most part, this has been pretty effective for people who have any taste or sense of culture. If you're a creator, or engaged in creative culture, you probably either can't stand the AI aest...